

Philipp Hilbert. *Product Manager, Digital Payments.*

Positioning, payments product manager with 13 years in regulated industries, a fintech founding track, and hands-on API and partner integration experience.

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§ WHY 7X

Digital payments infrastructure at the intersection of banks, MTOs, and regulatory frameworks is exactly where product decisions carry real consequences, a missed edge case in a partner integration is not a UX inconvenience, it is a compliance event or a settlement failure. 7X operates in that space, connecting financial institutions and payment corridors across the UAE under CBUAE oversight. What drew my attention specifically is the scope of partner integration work: banks, MTOs, and external API ecosystems are described as core to the roadmap, not peripheral, that is the problem space I have been building product intuition in since founding Kvitt Payment Solutions inside the girocard network. *That combination of regulatory seriousness and infrastructure ambition is exactly the environment where my strengths compound.*

§ HONEST FRAMING

I have not shipped a product specifically within CBUAE-regulated frameworks or worked directly with UAE-licensed MTOs. My regulated-payments experience is anchored in the EU (girocard, GDPR, and PSD-adjacent contexts). The underlying mechanics, partner onboarding, compliance gating, reconciliation edge cases, and regulator liaison, translate directly, and I close the CBUAE-specific gap fast.

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo requirement and spec drafts
- **GitHub Copilot**, code-assisted API and integration review
- **Cursor**, VSCode-based codebase navigation
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping for concept testing
- **GPT**, structured discovery and competitor analysis
- **Gamma.app**, stakeholder decks and roadmap presentations
- **n8n**, agentic workflow automation and partner integration testing
- **Framer**, high-fidelity user-flow prototypes

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

REST APIs, Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, Kubernetes, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps, CI/CD with Jenkins and GitLab, Azure DevOps, Dagster, dbt, SQL, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

§ SIDE PROJECT

CONSTRUCT8 [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

Two-sided B2B staffing marketplace built solo from zero to production.

- Anonymity-until-payment model protecting both firm and worker until commitment is established.
- WhatsApp and Telegram as primary product surface, reducing onboarding friction to zero for mobile-first users.
- LLM agents across the funnel handle day-to-day operations with one operator, demonstrating autonomous workflow design at the product layer.
- Demonstrates full zero-to-one ownership, discovery, spec, build, funnel analytics in SQL, transferable directly to MVP-first payment product development.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT 7X

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow every active partner integration, read the existing API documentation and CBUAE compliance artefacts, and map where requirements, delivery, and regulatory obligations currently misalign.

WEEK 2

Triage the backlog.

Run a structured prioritisation pass on the product backlog with business and tech stakeholders, surface the items with hidden compliance dependencies before they become delivery blockers.

WEEK 3+

Ship and close loops.

Drive the first MVP increment to production, establish a weekly rhythm with external partners and internal compliance, and instrument the first KPIs so product decisions have data behind them from day one.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Hiring Team at 7X,

Digital payments product management is where I have spent the most consequential part of my career. I founded Kvitt Payment Solutions, a mobile P2P group-payments product built from zero, taken to acquisition, and operated inside the Sparkasse girocard ecosystem. That experience taught me early what it means to own a payment product end to end, not just the roadmap and the user stories, but the partner onboarding, the reconciliation edge cases, the bank relationships, and the moments when a missed requirement surfaces as a settlement failure at 11pm on a Friday.

The Product Manager, Digital Payments role at 7X sits at the intersection of partner integrations, MTO relationships, bank connectivity, and CBUAE regulatory compliance. That is a familiar shape of problem. At Scheidt & Bachmann Fuel & Convenience Retail, I owned the integration product team in a SAFe organisation spanning POS systems, forecourt hardware, and payment flows across a matrix of stakeholders. I moved research results into production by

managing the dependency web, between agile release trains, external vendors, and internal operations, rather than hoping it would resolve itself. At EMIL Group, I shipped the Claims Center from concept to production and cut time-to-market for new insurance products from months to under a week, both by applying MVP discipline: agree what counts as done, build the smallest thing that proves it, iterate with data.

On the technical side, I work directly with APIs and integration teams. I can read a REST API specification, write a test harness, and identify the edge cases that will cause problems before they reach QA. At Bundesagentur für Arbeit I drove the ETL migration and containerisation programme while simultaneously carrying a full UI relaunch, because a product manager who cannot navigate a technical conversation with the team is a bottleneck, not a bridge. I bring the same fluency to partner API integrations: I do not just hand off a requirements document, I stay in the room until the integration works.

I am aware that I am not yet a holder of CBUAE-specific regulatory experience. I am also aware that this gap is a ramp, not a wall, the compliance mechanics of payment product management translate across jurisdictions, and I have a track record of getting up to speed in regulated environments quickly. My willingness to relocate to Abu Dhabi or Dubai is genuine, not hedged: the UAE is an active target in my search, not a stretch.

I would welcome a conversation about the specific partner integration challenges on your current roadmap and where you feel the product function needs the most support.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Product manager with 13 years of product ownership in regulated industries, fintech, insurance, public-sector analytics, and defence AI. I specialise in translating complex business and technical requirements into prioritised roadmaps, managing partner integrations and API-dependent product surfaces, and leading cross-functional delivery teams through Scrum and SAFe. My founding track in digital payments (Kvitt, acquired into the girocard network) gives me first-hand knowledge of the P2P payment product lifecycle from MVP to acquisition, including bank partnerships and regulatory constraints.

§ WHAT I CAN DO

Digital Payments & Partner Integrations: P2P payment product lifecycle, PSP and bank partner onboarding, API and web-based integrations, girocard ecosystem, MTO-adjacent partner flows

Product Strategy & Roadmap: continuous discovery, MVP definition, product vision, prioritisation, product lifecycle management, go-to-market support, PoC

Product Backlog & Prioritisation: backlog refinement, user stories, acceptance criteria, epics, sprint planning, velocity and burndown, release planning, Jira, Confluence

Business & Product Requirements: requirements engineering, user flows, functional specifications, UAT, A/B testing, user research and interviews

Agile / Scrum / SAFe: Scrum, Kanban, WIP limits, SAFe, ART, PI planning, Scaled Agile Framework

Data & Product Analytics: funnel and churn analysis, KPI definition, ETL, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, SQL, Matomo, MicroStrategy

Stakeholder Management & Compliance: cross-functional team leadership, C-level reporting, GDPR, Deputy IT Security Officer, risk and compliance gating, workshop facilitation, conflict resolution

AI Products and Tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt engineering, EU AI Act, Explainable AI; prototyping with Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable

Technical Environments: Kubernetes, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps, CI/CD, Jenkins, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin, SQL, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ · PRODUCT MANAGER · DEFENCE AI & DATA PLATFORM 2024-2025

GitOps delivery with ArgoCD cut rollout from days to 30 minutes; 200% pipeline-run increase by redirecting strategy to developer-code-first; led 15+ engineers and data scientists through Scrum on the FCAS European programme.

BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT · PRODUCT MANAGER · PUBLIC-SECTOR ANALYTICS 2023-2024

Integrated test automation into Jenkins, introduced Dagster and dbt saving 75% of time per data update, and migrated a bare-metal system to full containerisation while carrying a UI relaunch and ETL migration concurrently. Deputy IT Security Officer.

CLINET PLATFORMS · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE MOBILE APP
2023-2023

Cut a five-person team's roadmap to the top 10% of features by success-measure value: user acceptance rose more than fivefold; CGM hospital interface reduced anamnesis time from 30 to 5 minutes.

EMIL GROUP · PRODUCT MANAGER · INSURANCE B2B SAAS 2022-2022

Restructured an 18-person delivery organisation into three lean teams, reducing attrition from near-total exodus to one departure; shipped the Claims Center concept to production; cut new-product time-to-market from months to under a week.

SCHEIDT & BACHMANN · PRODUCT OWNER INTEGRATION · RETAIL & PAYMENTS 2021-2022

Moved research results into production across POS, forecourt systems, and payment integrations in a fully SAFe matrix organisation with agile release trains and PI planning.

BUNDESDRUCKEREI · PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM) · SECURE GOVERNMENT DATA 2021-2021

Data structures and identity management for Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

AOK ITSCARE · PRODUCT OWNER (PROXY) · HEALTH INSURANCE B2B PROCUREMENT 2019-2020

Migrated legacy system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and ~20,000 employees; still in production. Backlog refinement, user stories, and acceptance criteria in Jira.

WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE CLINICAL NETWORK 2017-2018

Wifi infrastructure rollout across nine hospitals.

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

CONSTRUCT8 · FOUNDER & PRODUCT MANAGER · B2B STAFFING MARKETPLACE 2025-2026

Zero to one: two-sided marketplace with anonymity-until-payment model, WhatsApp/Telegram as product surface, LLM agents across the funnel. Funnel and conversion analysis in SQL.

QCRYPT AG · CO-FOUNDER & PRODUCT OWNER · QUANTUM-SECURE
ENCRYPTION 2016-2021

Shipped a three-layer hardware-software product that installs in under two minutes; enterprise security product ownership including backup, restore/checkpoint, and encryption architecture. Later Chair of the board.

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS · FOUNDER & CFO · FINTECH P2P PAYMENTS
2013-2018

Built a mobile group-based P2P payment product from zero to acquisition; acquired and operated by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem.

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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